

Philipp Hilbert. *Technical Product Manager, AI Finance.*

Positioning, product manager with 13 years in regulated domains, payments, insurance, defence AI, who owns a vertical end-to-end and knows where AI earns its place.

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§ WHY BJAK

Bjak is one of the few companies in Southeast Asia that treats the full financial stack, payments, insurance, remittance, wealth, trading, as a single product problem rather than a portfolio of disconnected apps. The framing in the job description is precise and honest: these products move real money, and reliability, regulatory requirements, and third-party financial rails are fundamental, not afterthoughts. That is a product environment I recognise from building P2P payments inside the girocard ecosystem at Kvitt and from owning compliance-embedded delivery at EMIL Group's insurance platform. The explicit position that AI is a means, not the goal, matches how I actually work: instrument competing workflows, measure what people use, and apply automation only where it moves a real metric. *That discipline is harder to hold than it sounds, and it is exactly where I want to spend the next chapter.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo spec and edge-case generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, pair-programming across Python and SQL
- **Cursor / VSCode**, agentic refactors and context-aware edits
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **GPT**, structured document drafting and eval harnesses
- **n8n**, multi-agent and agentic workflow automation

- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder presentation and narrative
 - **Framer**, design-heavy prototype surfaces
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, Jenkins, CI/CD, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Django, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Dagster, dbt, SQL, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Two-sided B2B marketplace matching construction firms with workers, built alone from zero.

- Anonymity-until-payment model that protects both sides until commitment is confirmed.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the primary product surface; LLM agents handle funnel qualification and day-to-day operations.
 - Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL; one operator running the full loop.
 - Directly relevant to Bjak's zero-to-one fintech product challenge: lightweight rails, trust mechanics, and agent-assisted operations at minimal headcount.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT BJAК

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the existing payment and insurance rails end-to-end, API contracts, reconciliation flows, failure handling, regulatory touchpoints, and produce a written map of where the current system is fragile or undocumented before proposing anything.

WEEK 2

Instrument the vertical.

Define and instrument the three metrics that would tell us whether the assigned vertical is healthy: correctness rate, time-to-settlement, and user-facing error rate, so every subsequent trade-off has a number attached.

WEEK 3+

Ship and clear gates.

Take the highest-priority initiative through technical design, compliance review, and third-party dependency resolution in parallel, not sequentially, to reach the first production launch without waiting for a waterfall of approvals.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Bjak team,

I am applying for the Technical Product Manager, AI Finance role. My background spans 13 years of product ownership in regulated environments, payments, insurance, defence AI, public-sector data, and I have spent the last several years building the technical fluency to work as a genuine peer to engineering rather than a requester of features.

The part of your job description that resonated most directly was the explicit call to own a vertical end-to-end, from strategy through technical design, delivery, and launch, including the regulatory and third-party rails that actually gate launch. That is the work I know best. At EMIL Group I took the Claims Center from concept to production on an insurance platform serving reinsurers, brokers, and underwriters, a domain with the same combination of financial correctness requirements, compliance constraints, and multi-party API dependencies that characterises Bjak's stack. At Rohde & Schwarz I owned the internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme, managing cross-functional delivery across 15-plus engineers and data scientists while holding the line on audit trails, pipeline reliability, and hotfix capability. In both cases the job was not managing a backlog; it was holding the whole system in view, architecture, failure modes, regulatory gates, and user outcomes, simultaneously.

Your statement that AI is a means, not the goal, is one I agree with and one I have applied in practice. At Rohde & Schwarz I instrumented two competing product workflows, a UI-led approach and a developer-code-first approach, and the UI-led one recorded exactly zero clicks in production. The pipeline-runs metric that actually mattered rose 200 percent when we deprioritised the beautiful thing and shipped the useful one. That is the discipline your posting describes: knowing where AI genuinely improves an outcome, where deterministic systems must stay in control, and how to build products that are reliable, auditable, and trusted. I have

designed evaluation loops and human-in-the-loop safeguards for LLM-powered features, and I understand when the right answer is not to use a model at all.

On the fintech side, I co-founded Kvitt Payment Solutions and took a mobile P2P payments product from zero through acquisition by Sparkasse, operating inside the girocard ecosystem. That meant building payment flows, handling edge cases around transaction state and settlement, and navigating the regulatory environment of a licensed financial rails partner, the same class of constraints your payments and remittance verticals face. I also have direct experience with insurance as a product domain from EMIL Group, which aligns with Bjak's core insurance platform heritage.

Bjak is operating at a scale and in a market complexity, Southeast Asia, multiple currencies, multiple regulatory regimes, real money moving across payments, remittance, insurance, and trading, that I find genuinely compelling. I am ready to move fast, clear the gates that actually block launch, and hold engineering, compliance, and operations aligned around decisions that hold up when challenged.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product manager and owner with 13 years of end-to-end ownership in regulated, high-consequence domains: payments, insurance, defence AI, and public-sector analytics. I translate strategy, compliance constraints, and user needs into a prioritised roadmap, work as a peer to engineering on technical design and failure handling, and ship production software across agile and scaled delivery frameworks. My fintech foundation, founding and selling a P2P payments product inside the girocard ecosystem, gives me direct experience with the financial rails, regulatory gates, and correctness requirements that define AI Finance product work.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Payments and Fintech: payment flow design, PSP integration, P2P transaction handling, settlement edge cases, girocard ecosystem, financial rails

Regulated Product Delivery: KYC, transaction monitoring, GDPR (General Data Protection Regulation), EU AI Act, identity management, Deputy IT Security Officer, compliance-embedded delivery

AI Products and Tooling: LLM (large language model) agents, agentic workflows, prompt and context engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, AI governance, Explainable AI (XAI)

Platform and Data: ETL (extract, transform, load), Dagster, dbt (data build tool), PostgreSQL, Kafka, funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, MicroStrategy, Matomo

Technical Environments: Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, CI/CD, Jenkins, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Git, Azure DevOps

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, backlog refinement, sprint planning, release gating, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma

Product Management: continuous discovery, product roadmap, MVP definition, A/B testing, user research, go-to-market, fintech, insurance, platform

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAgile (Scaled Agile Framework), PI planning, agile release train

Stakeholder and Leadership: cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI AND DATA PLATFORM 2024-2025

Internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme; 15-plus engineers and data scientists. GitOps delivery with ArgoCD cut rollout from days to 30 minutes; pipeline runs up 200% after redirecting strategy to developer-code-first over UI-led design.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC-SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023-2024

National labour-market analytics platform; Deputy IT Security Officer. Introduced Dagster and dbt, saving 75% of time per data update; migrated bare-metal system to containers; automated Jenkins pipeline, freeing several QA hours weekly.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE APP 2023

Cut roadmap to top 10% of features; user acceptance rose more than fivefold. Implemented CGM interface into hospital information system (KIS): digital anamnesis from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS PLATFORM 2022

Restructured 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams; attrition fell from near-total exodus to one departure. Shipped Claims Center from concept to production; cut time-to-market for new insurance product from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER · RETAIL PAYMENTS AND POS 2021-2022

Payments and forecourt systems in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · SECURE GOVERNMENT DATA 2021

Data structures and identity management for Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY) · HEALTH INSURANCE E-COMMERCE 2019-2020

Migrated legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees; still in production.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · WIND ENERGY IT 2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · CLINICAL NETWORK 2017-2018

Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION STAFFING MARKETPLACE 2025-PRESENT

Zero to one: two-sided B2B marketplace with anonymity-until-payment model, WhatsApp and Telegram as product surface, LLM agents across the funnel.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE ENCRYPTION 2016-2021

Shipped three-layer quantum-resistant encryption product installing in under two minutes for enterprise buyers; later Chair of the board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO ·
NANOTECHNOLOGY AND AGRICULTURE 2018-2021

Lab to investor rounds; owned financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH P2P
PAYMENTS 2013-2018

Built mobile group-based P2P payments from zero; acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · BJAk

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